



MASAKHANE

AFRICAN LANGUAGES HUB

Brand Guidelines



LOGO

MASAKHANE AFRICAN
LANGUAGES HUB

PRIMARY LOCKUP

Primary Logo

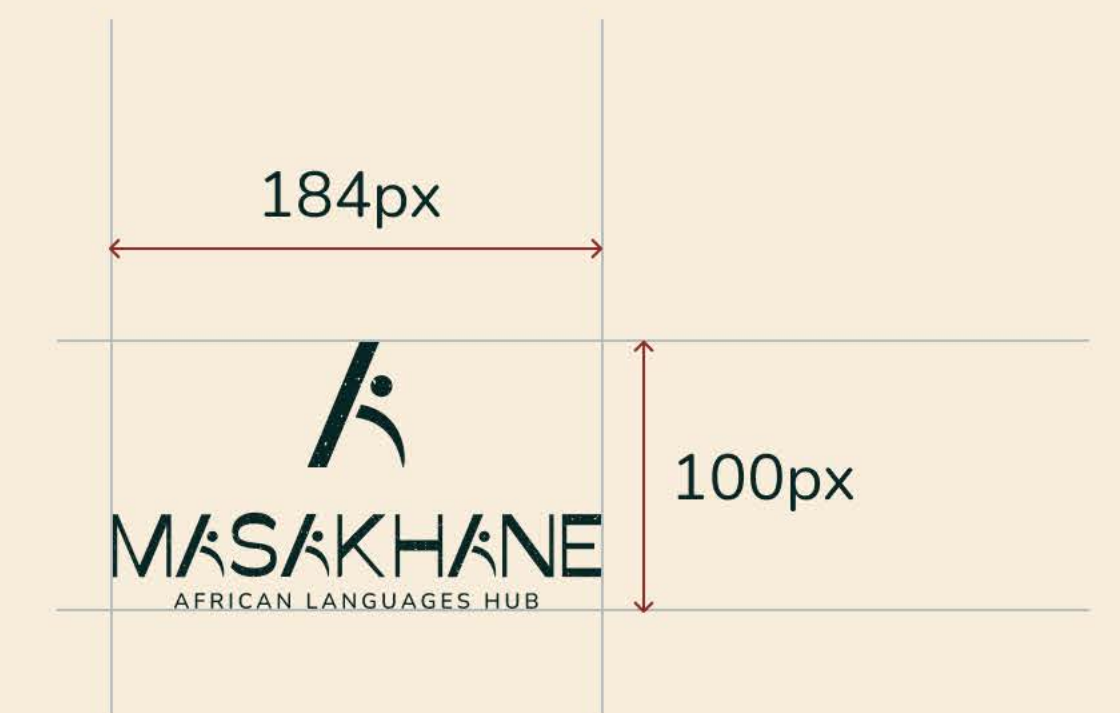
Our primary logo is the core identifier of the brand. It represents our voice, our values, and the experience we aim to create. This mark should appear on all major communications and serves as the most recognizable symbol of who we are.



MASAKHANE
AFRICAN LANGUAGES HUB

Minimum Size

To maintain clarity and legibility across all applications, the logo must never appear smaller than the established minimum size. This ensures the mark stays sharp, readable, and consistently impactful in every context.



WORDMARK

Wordmark logo

The wordmark highlights the brand name in its most direct form. It's used when clarity and brand recognition are the priority. This version is ideal for layouts where typography takes the lead or where the full name offers stronger presence than the symbol alone.

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Minimum Size



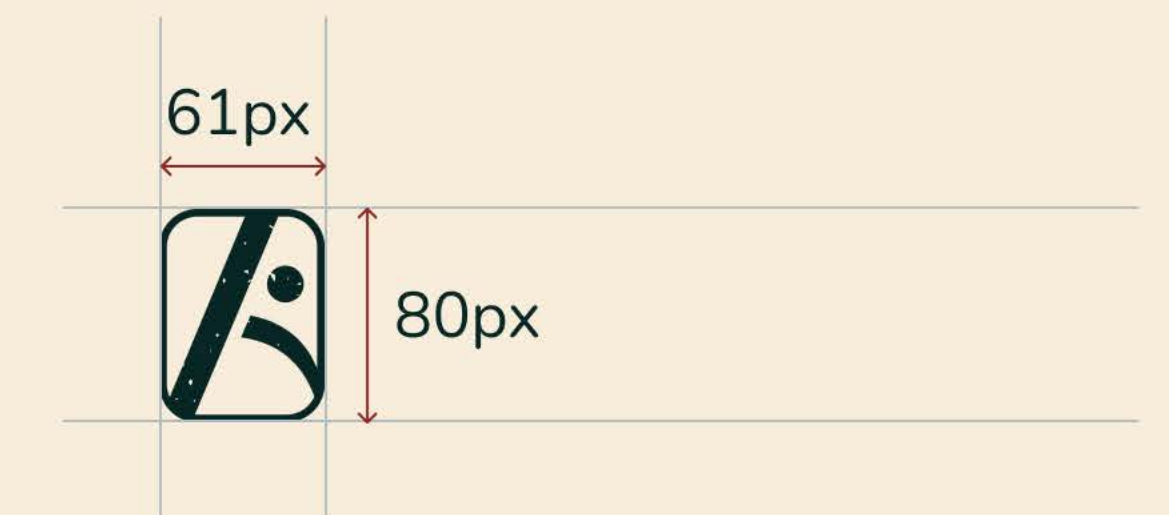
ICON ONLY

Icon-only logo

The icon-only logo is our most minimal expression. It's used in spaces where the full logo won't fit or where a simplified mark creates a cleaner visual impact. This version maintains brand recognition while offering flexibility across digital and compact applications.



Minimum Size



CONSTRUCTION

Logo Construction

The logo is built on a simple, intentional structure that defines its proportions and visual balance. These guidelines ensure the mark is consistent no matter where it appears. Following the construction helps maintain the logo's integrity and prevents distortion or improvisation.

Logo Exclusion Zone

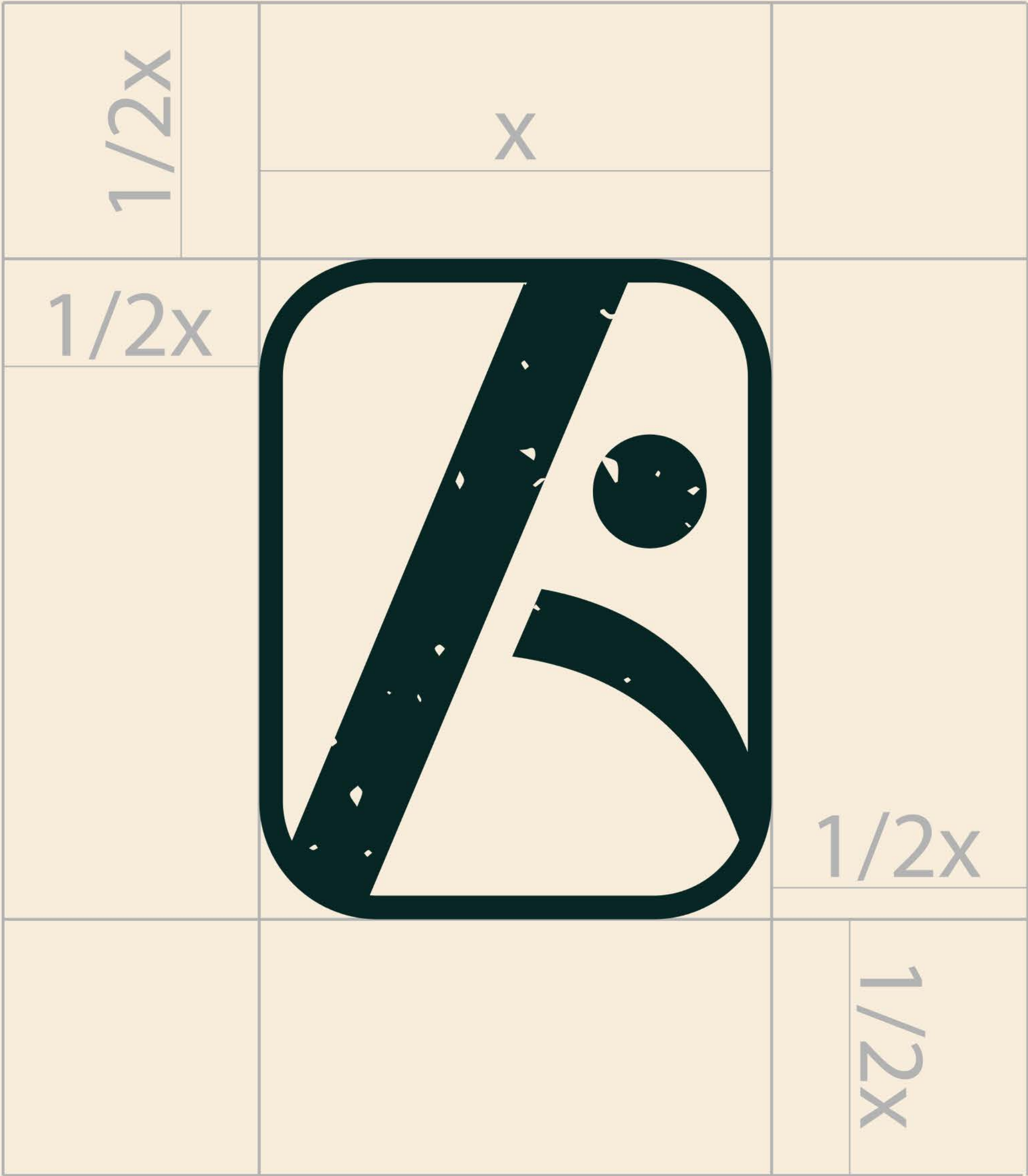
The exclusion zone protects the logo's visibility and impact. No text, graphics, or other elements may enter this space. Keeping this clear buffer ensures the logo always has room to breathe and remains unmistakably the focal point.



CONSTRUCTION



CONSTRUCTION



MONO-COLOUR LOGO

Mono-Coloured Logos

The mono-coloured logo offers a simplified expression of the brand for situations where full colour isn't practical. It ensures maximum clarity on limited palettes, high-contrast backgrounds, or production-restricted formats. This version keeps the brand recognizable while maintaining strong visual impact.



ALTERNATIVE BACKGROUNDS

Alternative-Coloured Logos

Alternative logo colours provide flexibility while still aligning with the brand's visual identity. These versions are used when the mono-coloured palette doesn't offer enough contrast or when a specific environment calls for a different tone. They support versatility without compromising consistency.



COMMON ERRORS

Common Logo Errors

To protect the integrity of the brand, avoid any modifications to the logo's form, colour, or proportions. Do not stretch, rotate, recolour, add effects, or place the logo on backgrounds that reduce legibility. These incorrect uses weaken recognition and disrupt the consistency the brand relies on.

Avoid rotating



Avoid Squeezing



Avoid Rearranging



Avoid Skewing



Avoid changing brand colours



Avoid moving logomark



Avoid Using Strokes



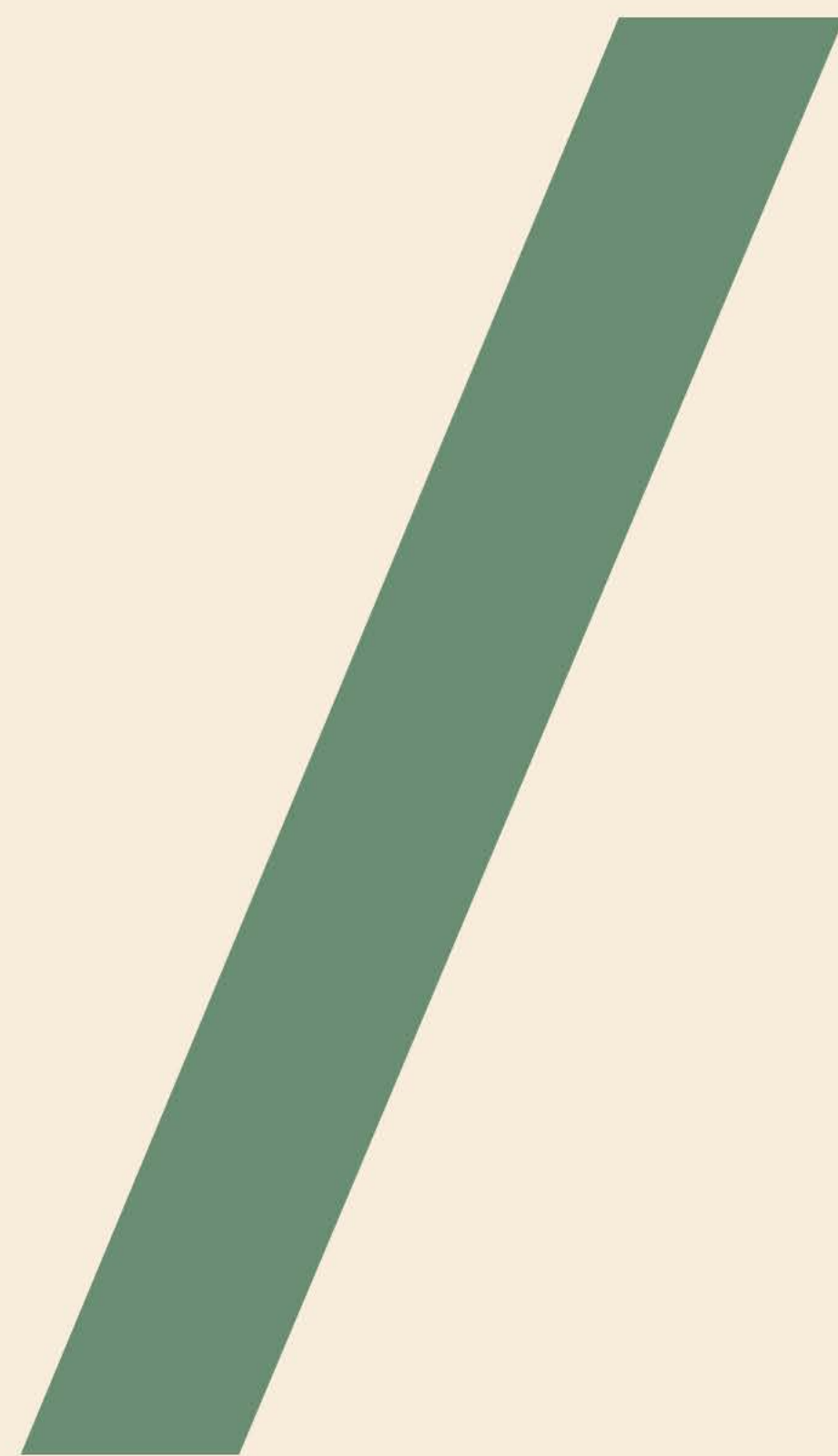
Avoid Boxing in logo



LOGO SYMBOLOGY

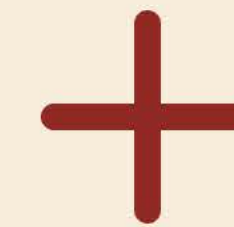
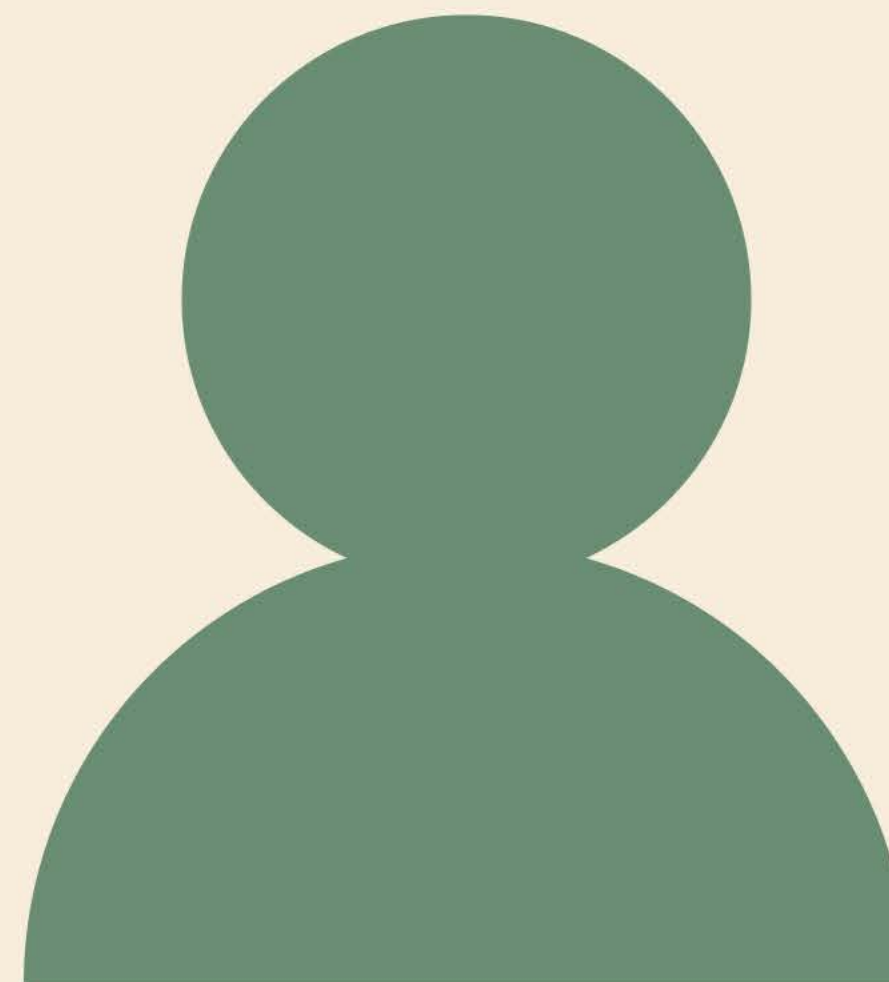
DASH

PROGRESS AND MOMENTUM



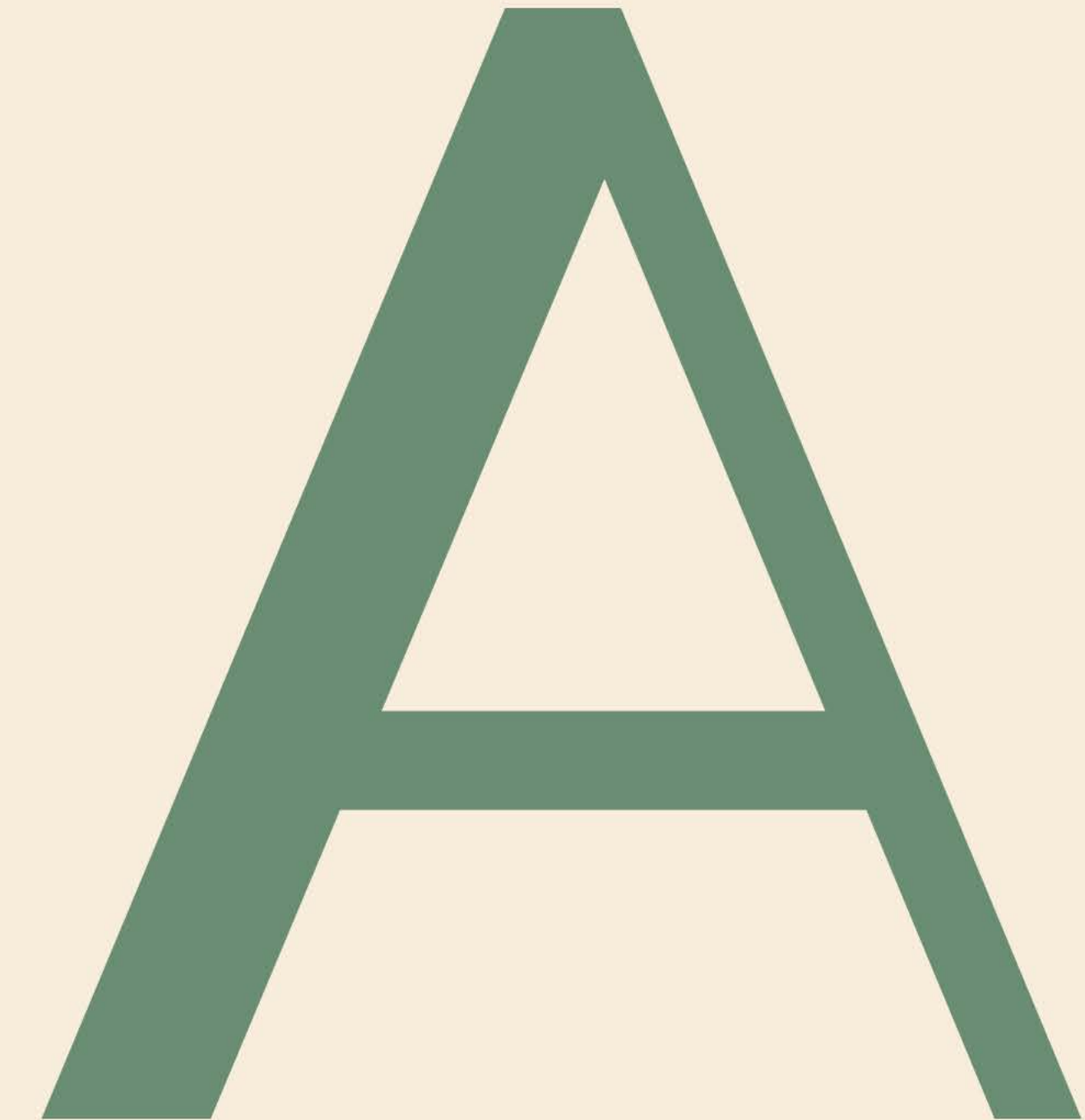
PERSON

COMMUNITY AND EMPOWERMENT



LETTER A

FOR **A**FRICANS, BY **A**FRICANS



LOGO SYMBOLOGY





COLOUR

MASAKHANE AFRICAN
LANGUAGES HUB

PALETTE

Takatso
Hex: #EA5E00
CMYK: 0%, 59.83%, 100%, 8.24%
RBG: 234, 94, 0

Je Ti
Hex: #082625
CMYK: 78.95%, 0%, 2.63%, 85.1%
RBG: 8, 38, 37

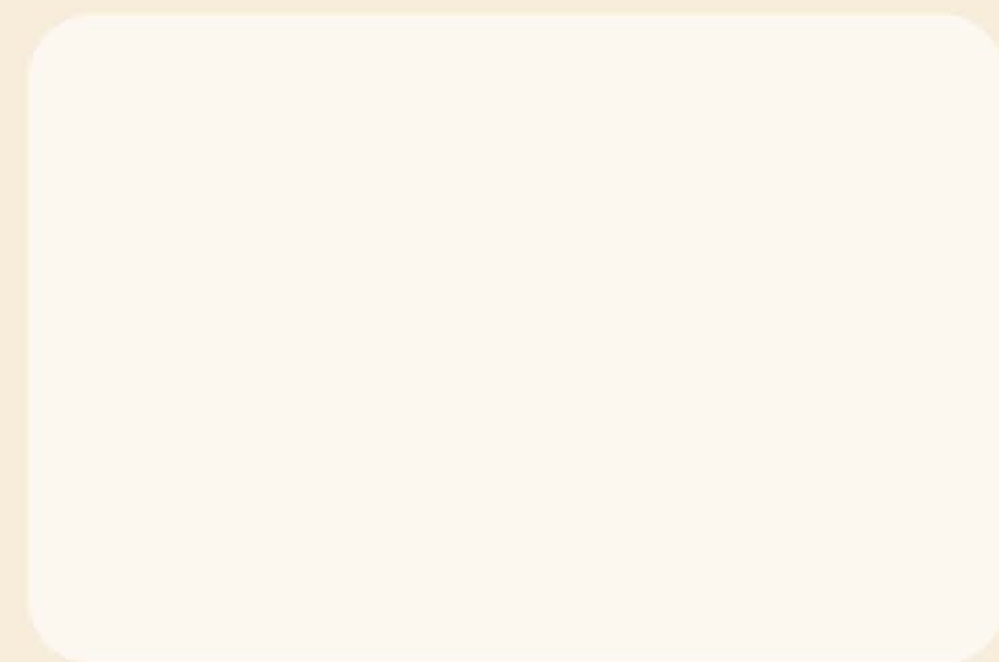
Zeri
Hex: #F8EDDB
CMYK: 0%, 4.44%, 11.69%, 2.75%
RBG: 248, 237, 219

Kubatana
Hex: #1E8983
CMYK: 78.1%, 0%, 4.38%, 46.27%
RBG: 30, 137, 131

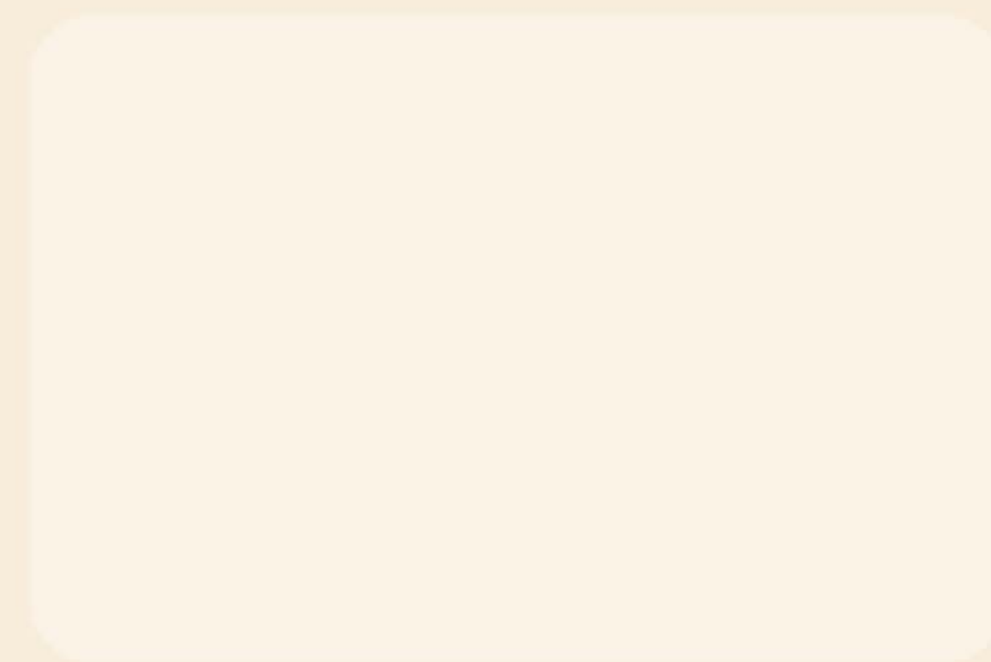
SHADES & TINTS

NEUTRAL PALETTE

Use for text colour and page backgrounds

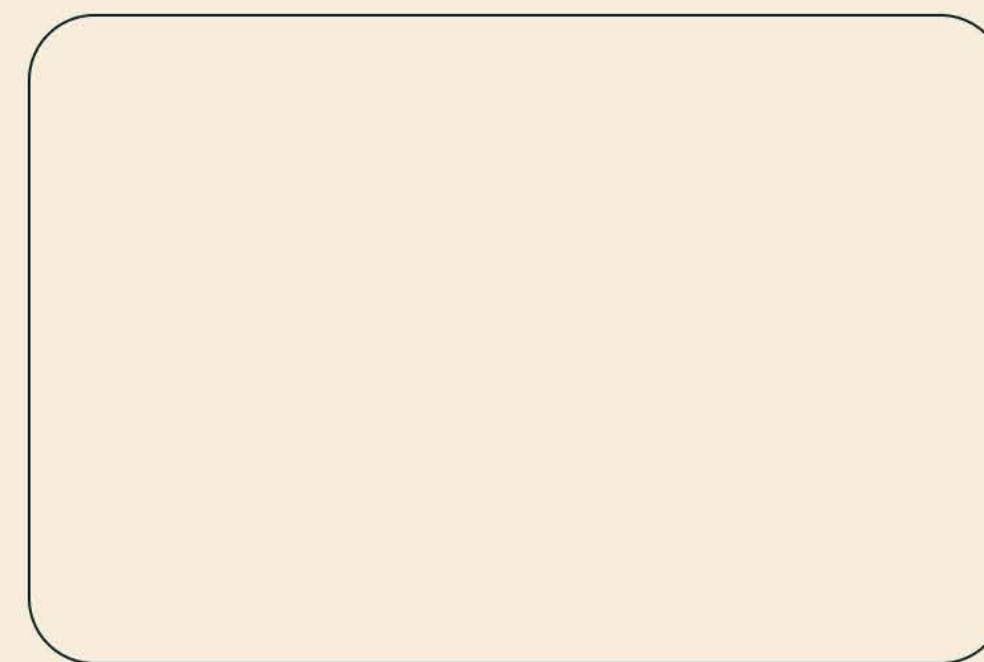


100



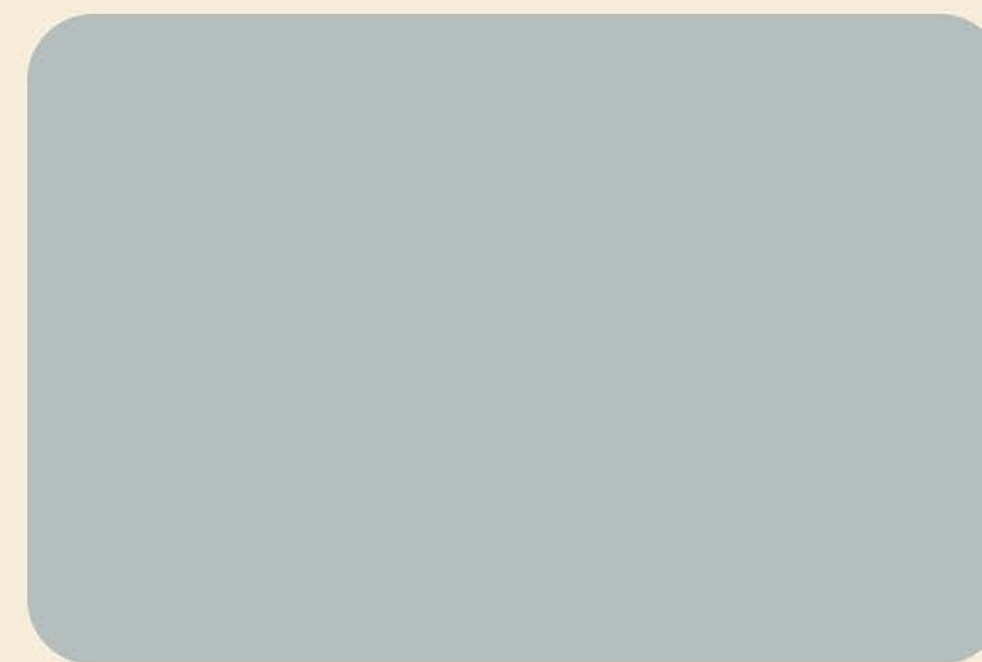
200

#FAF2E6



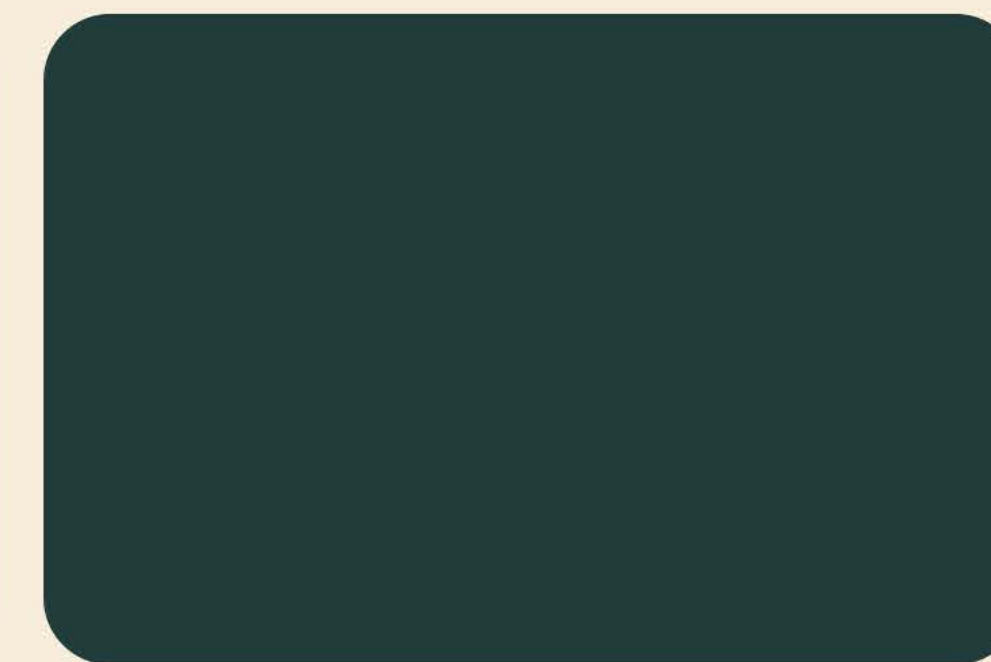
400

#F8EDDB



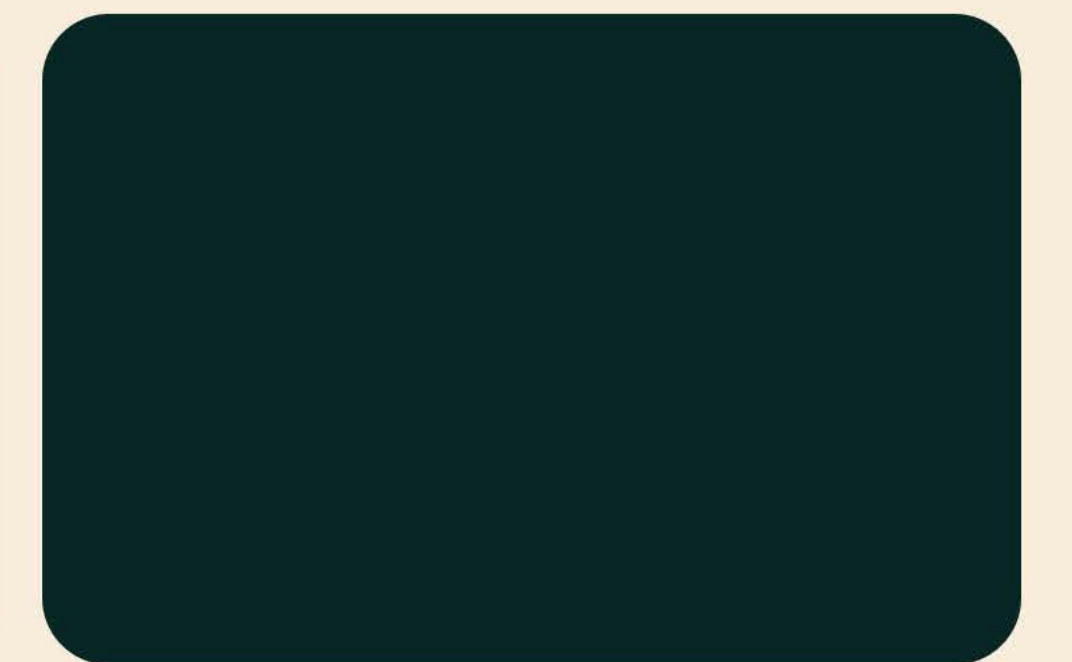
600

#B5BEBE



800

#213C3B



900

#082625

SHADES & TINTS

PRIMARY COLOUR

Use across all interactive elements such as CTA's, as well as branded components of the page



SHADES & TINTS

SECONDARY COLOUR

Use across as accents and for newly introduced features



APPROVED PAIRINGS



Approved Colour Pairings

These colour pairings show how our palette works together in a balanced, intentional way. Each combination is selected to maintain clarity, contrast, and brand cohesion across applications. Use only these approved pairings to ensure a consistent visual experience in all designs.

COLOUR MEANINGS

Takatso

Hex: #EA5E00

CMYK: 0%, 59.83%, 100%, 8.24%

RBG: 234, 94, 0

Takatso means desire. This colour symbolises the innovative spirit of the Masakhane African Languages Hub. This colour is bold, expressive, creative, and free. This represents the future Masakhane is working towards.

COLOUR MEANINGS

Je Ti

Hex: #082625

CMYK: 78.95%, 0%, 2.63%, 85.1%

RBG: 8, 38, 37

Je Ti means belong. This dark shade symbolises feeling of 'home' that the Masakhane African Languages Hub embodies. This colour is deep, rich, elegant, and alive. This represents the present that Masakhane is working in.

COLOUR MEANINGS

Kubatana

Hex: #1E8983

CMYK: 78.1%, 0%, 4.38%, 46.27%

RBG: 30, 137, 131

Kubatana means connection. This colour symbolises the people Masakhane African Languages Hub is bringing with them. This colour is kind, gentle, calming, and authentic. This represents the communities that Masakhane stands for.

COLOUR MEANINGS

Zeri

Hex: #F8EDDB
CMYK: 0%, 4.44%, 11.69%, 2.75%
RBG: 248, 237, 219

Zeri means seed. This colour symbolises the beginning of the Masakhane African Languages Hub. This colour is rooted, warm, true, and pure. This represents beginning of growth for Masakhane.



TYPOGRAPHY

MASAKHANE AFRICAN
LANGUAGES HUB

HEADING TYPE

Overview

Nunito

The quick brown
fox jumps over
the lazy dog.

Alphabets

AaBbCc

Numerals

0123

Aa1

BODY TYPE

Overview

Lato

The quick brown
fox jumps over
the lazy dog.

Alphabets

AaBbCc

Numerals

0123

Aa1

HIERARCHY & WEIGHT

Text Hierarchy

Our text hierarchy guides how information is organized and read. Each level from headings, subheadings, and body text has a defined role in leading the viewer’s eye. Using the correct hierarchy ensures clarity, structure, and a consistent reading experience across all brand communications.

Text Weight

Text weight reinforces emphasis and tone within our typography. Bold weights highlight key points, while regular and light weights support readability in longer passages. Using the specified weights maintains balance and ensures every message feels aligned with our brand voice.

Headings

Nunito
(SemiBold)

This is a cool Heading!

Subheadings

Nunito
(SemiBold)

This is a cool Heading!

Body Copy

Lato (regular)

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur.

Captions & small text

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur.

TYPE SCALE

Major Third - 1.25

Our type scale follows a 1.25 ratio, creating a harmonious progression between text sizes. This Major Third scale provides subtle, natural steps that improve readability and visual rhythm. Using this scale keeps typography consistent and ensures every layout feels balanced and intentional.

H1 - 61.04px 3.815rem | 45.78pt

Masakhane

H2 - 48.83px 3.052rem | 36.62pt

Masakhane

H3 - 39.06px 2.441rem | 29.30pt

Masakhane

H4 - 31.25px 1.953rem | 23.44pt

Masakhane

H5 - 25px 1.563rem | 18.75pt

Masakhane

H6 - 20px 1.250rem | 15.00pt

Masakhane

p - 16px 1.000rem | 12.00pt

Masakhane

small - 12.08px 0.800rem | 9.60pt

Masakhane



IMAGERY

MASAKHANE AFRICAN
LANGUAGES HUB

IMAGERY



IMAGERY



IMAGERY

Authentic Black & White

Our imagery centres on authentic black-and-white photographs of real African people. This approach highlights genuine expression and lived experience, removing distractions and allowing character, emotion, and story to come forward. The monochrome style creates consistency across applications while keeping the focus on the individuals who shape and inspire our work.



IMAGERY

People-Focused Imagery

Our imagery prioritises people at the heart of every story. Portraits and candid moments should feel natural, grounded, and human, showing real individuals, their expressions, and their everyday environments. By centring people in our visuals, we reinforce our commitment to community, representation, and the lived experiences that drive our mission.



USAGE EXAMPLES

Current Projects

These projects are at the inception stage, establishing broad coverage and foundational resources for future AI innovation and shaping the long-term ecosystem for African language AI.

Mapping of African language technologies, generation of 10M culturally grounded text and voice samples in 40 languages, development of TTS datasets/models, and voice-to-voice translation systems.

MASAKHANE

Current Projects

Gender responsive use cases integrating African languages with the intent of impacting 20 000 unique women in Economic Empowerment and Health in West and East Africa.

MASAKHANE

Current Projects

Scaling ASR model development to 100K hours of audio across 50+ languages and creating repeatable data infrastructure and benchmarking tools.

MASAKHANE



PATTERN

MASAKHANE AFRICAN
LANGUAGES HUB

PATTERN



PATTERN

Pattern

Our brand pattern adds texture, energy, and visual interest to layouts without overpowering the core elements. It's designed to complement the identity, reinforcing the brand's personality through subtle repetition and rhythm. Use the pattern thoughtfully to enhance compositions while keeping clarity and hierarchy intact.

The Masakhane African Languages Hub's pattern is inspired by woven fabrics and reed work, echoing traditional African craft and the heritage behind it. The interlaced forms reflect connection, community, and the strength found in shared histories. Used with intention, the pattern adds depth and cultural resonance while supporting the overall visual identity.



USAGE EXAMPLES



USAGE EXAMPLES

Our Mission

The Hub aims to establish a thriving ecosystem where African AI solutions are developed **locally, scaled for impact, and tailored to meet the continent’s diverse needs.**

By building a robust, inclusive ecosystem for African languages, the Hub will enable sustainable, locally appropriate AI solutions across a variety of socio-economic domains. Over time, the Hub aims to achieve impact in healthcare, education, agriculture, climate, and government services, with a focus on how these sectors contribute to improved livelihoods and socio-economic resilience in Africa.



Our values

We show up as a thoughtful and credible leader in the ecosystem, connecting the dots for a better outcome for African languages. We have positioned ourselves as collaborative and knowledgeable – allowing us to make impactful investments that centre us – African people.

- 01 **Collaboration** *with those working in the ecosystem to achieve a shared agenda*
- 02 **Community** *focus to ensure they are meaningfully engaged in the process*
- 03 **Care** *for the African ecosystem and ourselves as team to ensure we do not further exacerbate inequalities and harm though AI*



Extended Motif Usage

The woven pattern extends beyond a single graphic element and becomes a guiding motif throughout our layouts. Its structure informs background textures, framing devices, and subtle compositional accents. By carrying the same interlaced logic into larger design elements, the motif creates continuity, reinforces the brand’s crafted identity, and ties every application back to the cultural inspiration at its core.

LOGO BACKGROUND CONTROL

Logo Background Control

The picture mark may be used as a subtle background element to add depth without drawing attention away from primary content. When applied at low opacity or enlarged beyond recognition, it becomes part of the visual texture rather than a focal point. This controlled use maintains the integrity of the logo while reinforcing brand identity in a quiet, supportive way.



USAGE

MASAKHANE AFRICAN
LANGUAGES HUB



